Build a verb in three moves

VISUAL GUIDE • Keep this page beside you as you practice.

Conjugation means changing a verb so it matches who does the action. An infinitive is the starting form: hablar = to speak. Present tense describes what happens now or regularly: hablo = I speak / I am speaking.

1 Choose who

yo = I

2 Remove -ar

hablar → habl-

3 Add the ending

habl- + o = hablo

Who?	-ar	-er	-ir
yo	o	o	o
tú	as	es	es
él / ella / usted	a	e	e
nosotros / nosotras	amos	emos	imos
ellos / ellas / ustedes	an	en	en

hablar → hablo comer → como vivir → vivo

tú = you (one person, informal); usted = you (one person, formal).

Usted uses the él/ella form. Ustedes (you all) uses the ellos/ellas form.

Nosotros/nosotras = we. Ellos/ellas = they. Gender does not change the verb.

A name works too: Ana = ella; Ana y yo = nosotros; Ana y Luis = ellos.

Spanish often leaves out the subject: Hablo español. = I speak Spanish.

Quick self-check

Who is doing it? → Which verb family? → Which ending?

Use the same stem for every form of these regular verbs.

01 / Find the pieces

WORKSHEET A • Name: _____ Date: _____

A. Match the subject

Write yo, tú, él/ella/usted, nosotros/nosotras, or ellos/ellas/ustedes.

1. I: _____

2. you all: _____

3. Marta: _____

4. Luis and I: _____

B. Separate stem and ending

Example: hablar → habl- + -ar

5. estudiar → _____ + _____

6. comer → _____ + _____

7. vivir → _____ + _____

C. Build the form

Example: yo + hablar → habl- + o → hablo

8. tú + hablar → habl- + _____ → _____

9. nosotros + comer → com- + _____ → _____

10. ellas + vivir → viv- + _____ → _____

Say your steps out loud: “Who? Family? Ending?”

02 / Practice the pattern

WORKSHEET B • Use the guide first. Try the last four without it.

A. Complete each mini-chart

Who?	hablar	comer	vivir
yo	_____	_____	_____
tú	_____	_____	_____
nosotros / nosotras	_____	_____	_____
ellos / ellas / ustedes	_____	_____	_____

B. Write the matching present-tense form

1. ella / estudiar (to study): _____
2. ustedes / beber (to drink): _____
3. yo / escribir (to write): _____
4. tú / aprender (to learn): _____
5. nosotras / bailar (to dance): _____
6. él / abrir (to open): _____
7. ellos / leer (to read): _____
8. usted / escuchar (to listen): _____

Tip: -er and -ir share endings here except in nosotros: -emos / -imos.

03 / Use it and check it

WORKSHEET C • Try independently, then use the answer key together.

A. Complete the sentence

The infinitive and its English meaning are in parentheses.

1. Yo _____ español. (hablar = to speak)

2. Tú _____ agua. (beber = to drink)

3. Ana _____ en México. (vivir = to live)

4. Luis y yo _____ música. (escuchar = to listen)

5. Mis amigos _____ libros. (leer = to read)

6. Usted _____ la puerta. (abrir = to open)

B. Fix the verb and explain why

7. Yo hablas. → _____

8. Nosotros viven. → _____

Why? _____

C. Make it your own

Write one true sentence starting with Yo and one starting with Nosotros.
Use hablar, estudiar, comer, beber, vivir, or escribir.

_____

_____

Ready for Module 2? Aim for 7/8 on A + B without the guide twice,
on different days. If needed, repeat a few items with different subjects.